SUPPORT OPERATIONS / DEMONSTRATION PACK

NORTHSTAR WORKSPACE

Company Knowledge Base

A detailed support knowledge base for a fictional workplace equipment company. Products, commercial policies, troubleshooting, privacy, and service operations.

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This company and its commercial information are fictional. Example domains are nonworking placeholders. No real customer data or credentials are included. Effective policy snapshot: 1 November 2026. This is not live inventory or transaction data.

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Fictional company and demonstration data. Northstar Workspace, its products, staff roles, commercial terms, incidents, and operating practices in this document are invented for testing. All northstar.example domains and email addresses are reserved examples and are not working services. Prices are fictional, not offers for sale.

Document ID: NW-KB-2026-11. Version: 1.0. Effective date: 1 November 2026. Prepared: 13 November 2026. Owner: Customer Experience Operations. Classification: demonstration company knowledge. Currency: USD unless expressly stated. Default company timezone: Pakistan Standard Time, PKT, UTC+5. This document describes one fixed policy version, not live inventory, live delivery tracking, or current external information.

01. Company overview [ORG-01]

Northstar Workspace is a fictional direct-to-customer workplace equipment company founded in 2019. Its mission is to make compact home offices comfortable, reliable, and easy to support. Its headquarters and primary support team are in Lahore, Pakistan. Fictional fulfillment partners operate in Lahore, Austin, Leeds, and Dubai. A fulfillment partner is not a customer-facing shop; customers cannot collect or return products there without an approved appointment.

Northstar Workspace sells keyboards, desk lighting, laptop accessories, connectivity equipment, and ergonomic desk products. Its catalog serves individual professionals, students, remote teams, and small businesses. The company has 86 fictional employees: 16 in customer support, 20 in operations, 18 in product, 14 in engineering, 8 in finance and compliance, and 10 in people operations and administration. Department counts describe this demonstration snapshot only.

Northstar Workspace accepts consumer delivery addresses in Pakistan, the United States, the United Kingdom, and the United Arab Emirates. It does not currently accept consumer orders for Canada, Australia, the European Union, or other destinations. Bulk business orders to an unsupported country require a separately approved written quote and cannot be promised by frontline support.

Northstar Workspace operates an online store only. There are no walk-in retail stores, repair counters, public warehouse collection desks, or telephone sales lines in this demonstration. A support agent must not invent a warehouse street address, a local branch, a telephone number, or a payment account. The exact legal registration number, tax registration numbers, bank details, and employee personal contact details are deliberately absent from this knowledge base.

02. Contact channels and support hours [CONTACT-01]

The fictional store address is https://northstar.example. General customer support is support@northstar.example. Business purchasing is business@northstar.example. Invoice and payment investigations are billing@northstar.example. Privacy requests are privacy@northstar.example. Suspected account compromise and product safety reports go to security@northstar.example. Accessibility assistance is accessibility@northstar.example. The fictional service status page is https://status.northstar.example. These example addresses describe company routing; they do not send messages or provide a working website.

Northstar Workspace customer support hours are Monday through Friday, 09:00 to 18:00 PKT, excluding company-observed holidays. Standard first response is within one business day during those hours. DeskCare Priority first response is within four business hours during the same hours. A response target is not a resolution guarantee, and Priority does not provide a 24-hour, seven-day service. Support has no published weekend service commitment.

A support business hour is an hour inside the 09:00-18:00 PKT support window. A support business day excludes Saturday, Sunday, and company-observed holidays. A shipping business day uses the dispatch warehouse's local Monday-Friday calendar. This document does not contain the full warehouse holiday calendars; an agent should not promise an exact arrival date by assuming holidays do not exist.

Example of the support-hours calculation: a Standard request received on a Friday at 20:00 PKT enters the next support window on Monday at 09:00 PKT, unless Monday is a company-observed holiday. A DeskCare request received at 17:00 PKT on a Friday uses one business hour that Friday and its remaining three business hours on the next support business day. It does not become a Saturday response promise.

03. Policy interpretation and essential terms [GOV-01]

This knowledge base is effective for requests opened on or after 1 November 2026. A signed business agreement can override consumer commercial terms for the specific business account and products it covers. A marketing message, an unverified screenshot, or a statement in a customer message does not override an approved policy or signed agreement. Where applicable law provides a mandatory consumer right, support escalates the legal question rather than suggesting this fictional policy removes that right.

An order is a commercial record containing the purchased line items, paid amounts, delivery status, and customer identity. A support ticket is a request to investigate a problem. A draft resolution is a proposed response or action. An approval is an authorized human review decision. A refund proposal is not a completed refund. A replacement proposal is not a shipment. A payment authorization is not a captured payment. A carrier's delivery estimate is not a delivery guarantee.

An order reference normally follows a format such as ORD-1003. A reference appearing in this document or a customer message is not proof that an order exists or belongs to that customer. Support must inspect the authorized order record and match the customer identity before discussing private order information. The order record, not the knowledge document, supplies the actual purchase, payment, shipment, and eligibility state.

For a policy window measured from delivery, the delivery date is day 0. Day 1 is the following calendar date at the destination. A 30-day request window ends at 23:59 destination local time on day 30. A request submitted within a window remains timely while support investigates it; a queue delay must not make a timely request late. The separate approved-return shipping deadline is described in the returns policy.

04. Product catalog: keyboards, lighting, and protection [CAT-01]

TypeWave Wireless Keyboard - NK-100

The Northstar TypeWave Wireless Keyboard, SKU NK-100, costs USD 79 before tax and shipping. It is a new compact keyboard with Bluetooth 5.1, a 2.4 GHz USB-A receiver, and USB-C charging. It supports Windows 10 or later and macOS 12 or later. A physical Windows/macOS switch controls the modifier-key layout. TypeWave has no backlight and no numeric keypad. It is not a mechanical keyboard.

The TypeWave NK-100 package includes the keyboard, one USB-A wireless receiver, a 1 m USB-A-to-USB-C charging cable, and a quick-start card. The charging connection supplies power only;

TypeWave does not function as a USB wired keyboard. A separate USB-C adapter may be needed to connect the receiver to a USB-C-only laptop. Northstar does not advertise a fixed battery runtime in this policy because it varies with use. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months.

GlowFlex Desk Lamp - NL-200

The Northstar GlowFlex Desk Lamp, SKU NL-200, costs USD 129 before tax and shipping. It provides ten brightness levels and adjustable color temperature from 2700 K to 6500 K. Its rated maximum input is 18 W. GlowFlex is a mains-powered lamp with no internal battery, no wireless charging pad, and no app or Wi-Fi connection. It cannot be operated as an unplugged portable lamp.

The GlowFlex NL-200 package includes the lamp, an external 100-240 V AC adapter with a 24 V DC output, and a region-appropriate mains lead. Use the supplied adapter; a laptop USB-C charger is not a substitute for its barrel-connector adapter. The head is adjustable, but it must not be forced beyond its stops. The manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months. A damaged adapter or exposed wiring is a product safety issue: stop using the lamp and request a safety review.

Transit 14 Laptop Sleeve - NS-140

The Northstar Transit 14 Laptop Sleeve, SKU NS-140, costs USD 49 before tax and shipping. The internal compartment measures 345 x 245 x 24 mm. It is intended for laptops that fit within all three measurements; a 14-inch screen label alone does not establish fit. Transit 14 has a padded polyester exterior, one accessory pocket, and a zip closure. It is splash-resistant, not waterproof or submersible.

The Transit NS-140 package contains one sleeve and a care card. It includes no laptop, charger, shoulder strap, or tracking device. Clean it with a damp cloth and allow it to air-dry. Do not machine-wash, tumble-dry, or iron it. A wrong-size nonfaulty return follows the opened-product return rules if the sleeve has been opened but remains clean and undamaged. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 12 months and excludes normal cosmetic wear.

QuietClick Wireless Mouse - NM-210

The Northstar QuietClick Wireless Mouse, SKU NM-210, costs USD 39 before tax and shipping. It supports Bluetooth and a 2.4 GHz USB-A receiver and offers 800, 1200, and 1600 DPI settings. The mouse runs on one AA battery, which is not included. It is not rechargeable and has no USB-C charging port. It supports Windows 10 or later and macOS 12 or later for ordinary pointer functions.

The QuietClick NM-210 package contains the mouse, one USB-A receiver stored in its battery compartment, and a quick-start card. The two wireless modes are alternatives, not a promise of simultaneous multi-computer control. For pointer lag, check the battery, connection mode, receiver placement, and nearby wireless interference before declaring a hardware defect. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 12 months. Damage caused by leaking third-party batteries is excluded.

05. Product catalog: connectivity and power [CAT-02]

AeroDock 8 USB-C Hub - ND-800

The Northstar AeroDock 8 USB-C Hub, SKU ND-800, costs USD 149 before tax and shipping. Its eight ports are two USB-A data ports, one USB-C data port, one HDMI output, one gigabit Ethernet port, one SD slot, one microSD slot, and one USB-C Power Delivery input. USB data supports up to 10 Gbps where the host and attached device support that rate. Network speed also depends on the router, cable, and internet service.

AeroDock ND-800 HDMI supports up to 4K at 60 Hz with a compatible host, cable, and display. The laptop's USB-C port must support DisplayPort Alternate Mode for video. A USB-C connector alone does not establish video support. AeroDock does not include a DisplayLink graphics processor and does not turn a data-only USB-C port into a video output. Its USB-C data port does not provide a second display output.

AeroDock accepts up to 100 W USB-C PD input and reserves up to 15 W for the hub, leaving up to 85 W for the laptop when the power source supports it. The package does not include a charger or HDMI cable. A 65 W source cannot become a 100 W source through the hub. Power delivery depends on the adapter, cable, negotiated profile, and host. AeroDock's manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months.

Link65 USB-C Charger - NP-650

The Northstar Link65 USB-C Charger, SKU NP-650, costs USD 59 before tax and shipping. It has one USB-C Power Delivery output rated up to 65 W and accepts 100-240 V AC input. Its maximum 65 W profile is 20 V at 3.25 A. A device draws only a power profile it supports; Link65 cannot force a phone or laptop to consume 65 W. Its plug style is selected for the delivery region.

The Link65 NP-650 package includes the charger and one 1.8 m Link100 USB-C cable rated for 100 W. The charger still outputs at most 65 W when used with that cable. Link65 can power AeroDock, but the hub may reserve up to 15 W, so no more than 50 W is available to the host from this 65 W source. Link65's manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months. Disconnect it if the housing cracks, liquid enters it, or a burning smell occurs.

Link100 USB-C Cable - NCB-100

The Northstar Link100 USB-C Cable, SKU NCB-100, costs USD 19 before tax and shipping. It is a 1.8 m USB-C-to-USB-C cable with a 5 A electronic marker and power support up to 100 W at 20 V. USB data is limited to USB 2.0, up to 480 Mbps. Link100 is a charging and basic-data cable, not a Thunderbolt cable or a display cable. It does not support USB-C video output.

The Link100 NCB-100 package contains one cable. A 100 W cable rating does not mean a connected charger outputs 100 W. Actual charging is limited by the lowest relevant capability of the charger, cable, and device. Repeated bending at the connector, damage from crushing, and exposed conductors require replacement of the cable rather than continued use. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 12 months.

Hub4 USB-A Hub - NH-400

The Northstar Hub4 USB-A Hub, SKU NH-400, costs USD 35 before tax and shipping. It connects to a USB-A host and provides four USB-A data ports with a shared USB 3 data link rated up to 5 Gbps. The shared figure is a host-link maximum, not 5 Gbps guaranteed independently on every port. Hub4 does not provide USB-C Power Delivery, HDMI, Ethernet, or laptop charging.

The Hub4 NH-400 package contains the hub with its attached host cable and a quick-start card. It is designed for ordinary low-power accessories such as a keyboard, mouse, or flash drive. Several high-power external drives may need their own power supplies. Hub4 is not an alternative to the AeroDock video adapter. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 12 months.

06. Product catalog: comfort, video, and desk equipment [CAT-03]

RiseStand Aluminum Laptop Stand - NS-300

The Northstar RiseStand Aluminum Laptop Stand, SKU NS-300, costs USD 69 before tax and shipping. It supports laptops from 11 to 17 inches with a maximum load of 7 kg, subject to the laptop fitting securely on the support surface. It has six mechanical height positions, silicone contact pads, and a fold-flat design. RiseStand has no fan, motor, charging electronics, or USB hub.

The RiseStand NS-300 package includes the stand and a carry pouch. Place it on a stable, level desk and check that both support points engage before placing a laptop on it. Do not adjust its height while a laptop is on it. A damaged or missing pad should be reported before further use. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months, and misuse above the rated load is excluded.

FocusCam 1080 Webcam - NC-100

The Northstar FocusCam 1080 Webcam, SKU NC-100, costs USD 89 before tax and shipping. It provides up to 1920 x 1080 video at 30 frames per second, two microphones, a fixed-focus lens, and a mechanical privacy shutter. It uses USB Video Class and supports Windows 10 or later and macOS 12 or later. FocusCam does not support 4K, face authentication, or a motorized pan-and-tilt function.

The FocusCam NC-100 package includes the camera, a 2 m USB cable, a USB-A adapter, and a monitor clip. Software camera permissions and the selected camera source can block video even when the camera is connected. The privacy shutter physically covers the lens; microphone access is controlled separately by the operating system or application. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months.

ClearCall USB Headset - NH-220

The Northstar ClearCall USB Headset, SKU NH-220, costs USD 99 before tax and shipping. It is a wired USB headset with a boom microphone, inline mute and volume controls, and microphone environmental noise reduction. Microphone noise reduction is not active noise cancellation in the earcups. ClearCall has no Bluetooth, no battery, and no 3.5 mm analog connection.

The ClearCall NH-220 package includes the headset with a USB-A connection, one USB-C adapter, and a quick-start card. Select ClearCall as both speaker and microphone in the meeting application. The inline mute state and an application's mute state may be separate. Inspect both during troubleshooting. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months; normal ear-pad wear is excluded.

GlideMat Extended Desk Mat - NM-900

The Northstar GlideMat Extended Desk Mat, SKU NM-900, costs USD 29 before tax and shipping. Its dimensions are 900 x 400 x 3 mm. It has a fabric top and nonslip rubber base, with no lighting, heater, charging coil, or electronics. A new mat may need up to 48 hours on a flat surface to settle after unrolling. That settling period is a care recommendation, not a return-window extension.

The GlideMat NM-900 package contains one rolled desk mat. Spot-clean with mild soap and cool water, then air-dry fully before use. Do not bleach, tumble-dry, or place a hot appliance directly on it. Surface abrasion and stains from ordinary use are not manufacturing defects. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 12 months.

AirCool Laptop Cooling Pad - NF-150

The Northstar AirCool Laptop Cooling Pad, SKU NF-150, costs USD 45 before tax and shipping. It supports laptops up to 15.6 inches that fit safely on its surface. It has two fans, three fan-speed settings, and a USB 5 V power connection. AirCool does not charge a laptop and does not include a mains adapter. Cooling improvement varies with laptop ventilation and room conditions; no temperature reduction is guaranteed.

The AirCool NF-150 package includes the cooling pad and one USB power cable. Keep its intake clear and remove surface dust while disconnected. Stop using it if a fan blade is damaged or a cable exposes conductors. Do not spray cleaner into the fan assembly. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 12 months.

DeskSense Monitor Light - NL-320

The Northstar DeskSense Monitor Light, SKU NL-320, costs USD 89 before tax and shipping. It draws USB-C power at 5 V, 2 A and is intended for compatible flat monitors with a bezel thickness from 5 to 35 mm. It has five brightness settings and three color-temperature settings. It is not approved for curved monitors or laptop screens, and it has no built-in battery.

The DeskSense NL-320 package includes the light, its mounting assembly, and a USB power cable. A power adapter is not included. Check that the monitor's top edge supports the clamp without pressing on a camera or fragile panel. Do not select DeskSense merely because a monitor has a USB port; mechanical fit matters too. Its manufacturing-defect warranty is 24 months.

Orbit Monitor Arm - NA-270

The Northstar Orbit Monitor Arm, SKU NA-270, costs USD 119 before tax and shipping. It supports one monitor from 17 to 32 inches weighing between 2 and 9 kg, excluding the monitor's original stand. Compatible VESA mounting patterns are 75 x 75 mm and 100 x 100 mm. Screen diagonal alone does not establish compatibility; weight and mounting pattern must also match.

The Orbit NA-270 clamp fits suitable desks 10-60 mm thick. Glass desks and hollow-core desks without an approved reinforcement arrangement are unsupported. The package includes the arm, clamp hardware, common VESA screws, and a hex key; unusual monitor spacers may need to be sourced separately. Orbit's manufacturing-defect warranty is 36 months. Damage caused by an unsuitable desk, incorrect mounting, or exceeding the weight range is excluded.

Renew TypeWave Refurbished Keyboard - NK-100-R

The Northstar Renew TypeWave Refurbished Keyboard, SKU NK-100-R, costs USD 55 before tax and shipping. It is a tested refurbished version of NK-100 with the same advertised connection modes and operating-system support. It may have small cosmetic marks that do not affect operation. The receiver and charging cable are included. Original retail packaging is not guaranteed.

Renew NK-100-R is offered only for Pakistan and United States delivery addresses in this policy version, subject to stock. It has a 12-month manufacturing-defect warranty rather than the new NK-100's 24-month warranty. Nonfaulty refurbished returns have a 14-calendar-day request window and a 10% item-price restocking deduction. The deduction does not apply to a confirmed

manufacturing defect, transit damage, or a Northstar fulfillment error.

07. Compatibility, bundles, and product selection [COMPAT-01]

The Home Office Essentials bundle contains one new TypeWave NK-100, one new GlowFlex NL-200, and one new Transit NS-140. Individually these cost USD 79, USD 129, and USD 49, totaling USD 257 before tax and shipping. The bundle costs USD 229 before tax and shipping. The bundle saving is USD 28. No additional coupon can be stacked on the bundle price unless the approved campaign terms explicitly permit it.

For a partial return from the Home Office Essentials bundle, finance allocates the USD 229 paid item total proportionally to the original individual list prices of 79:129:49. Support must use the invoice's allocated paid amounts and any documented rounding adjustments, not refund each returned component at full list price. The item-specific return condition and warranty still apply. This knowledge base does not provide a live invoice allocation for any customer.

The Video Meeting Pair contains FocusCam NC-100 and ClearCall NH-220 for USD 169 before tax and shipping, compared with USD 188 bought separately. Its saving is USD 19. The Video Meeting Pair does not include a light, docking station, monitor, subscription, or computer. Use the invoice allocation if only one item is returned.

For a customer who needs a single 4K 60 Hz external display, Ethernet, memory cards, and USB accessories, AeroDock may fit only if the host supports the required USB-C video mode. Hub4 cannot supply video or Ethernet. Link100 cannot be used as a video cable. A salesperson or support agent must ask for the exact laptop model and relevant port specification when compatibility is uncertain; a USB-C connector shape alone is insufficient.

For laptop power, distinguish a cable rating, a charger rating, and power left after a hub's own budget. Link100 is rated for up to 100 W, Link65 supplies up to 65 W, and AeroDock can reserve up to 15 W. Link65 through AeroDock can therefore leave at most 50 W for a compatible laptop. A laptop requiring 90 W is not promised full-speed charging by that combination.

08. Prices, discounts, payments, and invoices [BILL-01]

All catalog prices in this document are USD item prices before applicable tax and shipping. Checkout displays the final payable currency and total before payment. Northstar does not publish a fixed PKR, GBP, or AED exchange rate in this knowledge base. A support agent must not invent a local-currency conversion, tax amount, customs charge, or live promotion. Historical invoices retain their original currency and paid amounts.

The fictional store accepts supported Visa and Mastercard payments through its approved checkout processor. It does not accept cryptocurrency, cash sent by post, payment to an agent's personal account, or a card number sent through a ticket. Business bank transfer is available only when an approved business quote supplies verified instructions through the established purchasing channel. This document intentionally contains no bank details.

The WELCOME10 demonstration coupon gives 10% off eligible full-price individual new products for a first consumer order, up to a USD 20 discount. It excludes bundles, refurbished products, clearance items, DeskCare subscriptions, gift balances, tax, and shipping. Only one promotional code can apply per order. A code is valid only if checkout accepts it; its mention here does not prove a particular account or order is eligible.

For an eligible first order containing only a new TypeWave at USD 79, WELCOME10 would reduce the item price by USD 7.90 to USD 71.10 before tax and shipping. For USD 300 of eligible items, the 10% calculation would be USD 30, but the cap reduces the actual coupon discount to USD 20. A product's list price is not the correct refund amount when a discount reduced the paid item price.

An authorization hold can appear before payment capture. A pending authorization and a captured charge are not automatically duplicate payments. For a report of being charged twice, Billing checks processor transaction IDs and capture states before promising a refund. The customer may provide a redacted statement showing dates, amounts, and the last four card digits, but support must never request the full card number, CVV, PIN, or one-time password.

Order confirmation is expected within 30 minutes of an accepted checkout. If it is missing, check spam, the checkout email address, and the authorized order record. A confirmation-email delay does not justify asking the customer to pay again. A tax invoice is available after payment capture. Corrections to an issued invoice require Billing review; support may not edit a customer's legal tax details without verification or fabricate a tax registration number.

09. Order changes and cancellations [ORDER-01]

An order in processing can be submitted for a cancellation or address-change review before its warehouse picking lock. Picking normally begins within four business hours, but a four-hour cancellation right is not guaranteed. Warehouse picking can start sooner. Support must check the actual fulfillment state rather than treating the processing label as proof that a change remains possible.

After a shipment is handed to the carrier, support cannot promise an address change, delivery intercept, or cancellation. A carrier may independently offer a verified delivery-management option. If an item is already shipped, an unwanted-order request follows the relevant return policy after delivery. Creating a ticket or drafting a response does not cancel the shipment.

Changing the delivery country, adding products, or switching the payment method requires a new checkout rather than editing a captured order. Removing a line before picking requires an approved adjustment and updated paid amount. A subscription cancellation is different from a physical-order cancellation and follows the DeskCare policy. Support should identify which type the customer means before proposing a financial action.

An order is not treated as cancelled until the authorized system records the cancellation. If a captured payment needs to be returned, Billing follows the approved refund path. A card authorization that was never captured is released according to the payment processor and issuing bank, not described as a completed merchant refund. This knowledge base has no live picking status or processor transaction data.

10. Shipping regions, charges, and delivery estimates [SHIP-01]

Northstar normally dispatches stocked consumer products within two warehouse business days after payment acceptance. The daily processing cutoff is 14:00 in the dispatch warehouse's local time. An order accepted after the cutoff starts its processing count on the next warehouse business day. Preorders and separately quoted business shipments use their written dates instead of this standard dispatch target. Inventory and dispatch dates must be checked in the operational record.

Standard shipping to ordinary supported addresses in Pakistan, the United States, the United Kingdom, and the United Arab Emirates normally takes three to five shipping business days after dispatch. Remote-area standard delivery normally takes five to eight shipping business days after dispatch. The delivery estimate is additional to processing time. A two-day processing target plus a three-to-five-day standard transit estimate is not a promise of arrival two days after checkout.

Express shipping, when offered at checkout, normally takes one to two shipping business days after dispatch in Pakistan, the United States, and the United Kingdom. United Arab Emirates express normally takes two to three shipping business days after dispatch. Express is unavailable for remote areas and unsupported postcodes. It does not remove the normal processing period. All transit figures are estimates, not guaranteed service levels.

Standard consumer shipping costs USD 6 for a paid merchandise subtotal below USD 100 and USD 0 for a paid merchandise subtotal of USD 100 or more. The threshold is measured after merchandise discounts and before tax, shipping, and DeskCare charges. Express costs USD 18 where available, regardless of whether standard shipping would have been free. Free standard shipping does not create free express shipping.

Remote-area orders incur an additional USD 8 shipping surcharge even when their standard base shipping charge is zero. Checkout identifies an eligible remote postcode before payment; this knowledge base does not contain the complete postcode list. A USD 110 discounted merchandise subtotal with remote standard delivery therefore has USD 0 base shipping plus USD 8 remote surcharge, before tax. Do not infer a remote surcharge from a city name without checkout evidence.

Orders may arrive in separate parcels. A delivered status for one parcel does not establish delivery of every item in a split order. Tracking can take up to 48 hours after dispatch to show its first carrier scan. Shipment emails and tracking links are informational; support must obtain the actual current tracking record to answer where a particular parcel is. The company has no guaranteed same-day service and no general international shipping program outside the four supported consumer countries.

11. Delays, missing parcels, and wrong-item deliveries [SHIP-02]

If no first tracking scan appears after 48 hours from dispatch, Fulfillment opens a carrier inquiry after verifying the tracking reference and handover record. A stale scan alone does not prove loss. If a parcel exceeds the upper end of its applicable transit estimate, support collects the last scan and destination details and escalates it to Fulfillment. Northstar does not automatically refund every late parcel.

A carrier investigation normally takes up to five shipping business days after the inquiry is accepted. This is an investigation target, not an extra delivery promise. If the carrier confirms loss, Fulfillment and an authorized reviewer can offer a replacement subject to stock or a refund of the eligible paid amount. If the parcel is still under investigation, the draft response must describe that state and avoid saying the refund or replacement has already happened.

For a parcel marked delivered but not located, the customer should check safe places, household members, a building reception desk, and any carrier delivery photo. The customer should report the issue within seven calendar days of the delivered scan. Fulfillment checks the delivery evidence and starts a carrier review when appropriate. A delivered scan and a customer's denial must both be investigated; neither alone authorizes an automatic refund.

For a wrong item or missing item inside a received parcel, request the order reference, the affected line item, a photo of the received product or contents, and the package label with unnecessary personal details covered. Report the mismatch within seven calendar days of delivery. Northstar pays the approved corrective shipment and, when needed, supplies a prepaid return method. No restocking deduction applies to a confirmed Northstar fulfillment error.

If tracking shows a parcel is being returned to sender, support checks the carrier reason before proposing another shipment. An incorrect address supplied by the customer, a failed customs clearance, damage, and a carrier handling error are different cases. Additional charges or eligibility depend on the verified reason; an agent must not invent a universal redelivery fee. Do not create repeated replacement orders while an earlier corrective shipment is already active.

12. Return eligibility and authorization [RET-01]

For a new, unopened, nonfaulty physical product, the customer must request a return within 30 calendar days of delivery. The packaging must remain factory-sealed, and the original included accessories must be present. For an opened, nonfaulty new product, the request window is 14 calendar days from delivery. The opened product must be clean, complete, undamaged, and suitable for resale. Opened nonfaulty new-product returns have a 15% deduction from the paid item price.

For a nonfaulty refurbished product such as Renew NK-100-R, the request window is 14 calendar days from delivery. A 10% deduction from the paid item price applies, whether the refurbished packaging has been opened or not. Refurbished goods do not inherit the new unopened product's 30-day change-of-mind window. Their listing's described cosmetic condition is not itself a manufacturing defect.

Confirmed manufacturing defects reported within the first 30 calendar days, confirmed transit damage, and Northstar fulfillment errors have no restocking deduction. A defect first reported after 30 days follows the product's warranty rather than automatically creating an unrestricted change-of-mind refund. Clearance marked final sale excludes change-of-mind returns, but does not cancel applicable defect remedies, a published warranty, or mandatory legal rights.

Return authorization is required before sending goods. The approved authorization identifies the item, return destination, deadline, and shipping method. Customers must not send goods to an address found through an unrelated web search or to a fulfillment warehouse without authorization. The customer has seven calendar days after the authorization is issued to hand the package to the approved carrier and retain proof of handover. A requested extension needs written support approval.

For a change-of-mind or wrong-size return, the customer pays return shipping unless a promotion or written approval says otherwise. For a confirmed manufacturing defect, transit damage, or Northstar fulfillment error, Northstar supplies or reimburses the specifically approved return method. Reimbursement of an unapproved premium courier is not guaranteed. Products must be packed securely, with accessories and any issued return identifier included.

Return requests outside the published window, incomplete packages, signs of misuse, disputed delivery dates, and unclear product condition require manual review. A support agent may describe the policy and request evidence but cannot promise an exception. A policy document alone does not establish that a particular order is refundable; verify the operational record, item condition, dates, and any prior resolution.

13. Refund amounts, timing, and exceptions [RET-02]

An approved item refund is based on the actual paid item amount after allocated discounts, not the current price or original list price. Apply any valid restocking deduction to that paid item amount. Tax is adjusted only as required by the verified invoice and applicable tax treatment. Support must not fabricate a tax adjustment when the invoice or rules are unavailable. A bundled product uses its invoice allocation rather than its individual full list price.

For example, an opened nonfaulty new TypeWave purchased at the full USD 79 item price and returned within 14 days has a 15% restocking deduction of USD 11.85. Its item refund before any tax adjustment is USD 67.15. A nonfaulty Renew keyboard purchased for USD 55 has a 10% deduction of USD 5.50, leaving USD 49.50 before tax adjustment. These examples exclude shipping and do not describe a particular customer's live eligibility.

Original outbound shipping is not refunded for a change-of-mind return. If every item in an order is returned because of confirmed Northstar error or transit damage, the original outbound shipping charge is included in the approved resolution. For a partial fault return, Billing determines any eligible shipping allocation from the actual invoice. A free shipping charge of USD 0 does not create an additional cash shipping refund.

Returns are normally inspected within three business days after receipt at the authorized return center. After inspection and authorized approval, Northstar submits a refund within two business days. The issuing bank or payment provider may take a further five to ten business days to show the funds. These are separate stages. The agent must not promise that a refund appears in the bank account immediately after approval or immediately after the customer posts a parcel.

Refunds go to the original payment method. A request to refund to another person's card, a cryptocurrency wallet, a gift code, or an agent's bank account must be escalated to Billing and Security. If the original card expired, Billing investigates the processor's supported route; support does not collect replacement card details in a ticket. A refund proposal awaiting approval must be described as proposed, not paid or completed.

Where an order is already refunded, the agent must inspect the prior resolution before proposing anything else. The same item cannot receive a second full refund because the customer opens a new ticket or refreshes the page. A product replacement and refund for the same incident require a documented exception, not two independent approvals. Prior transaction references and approved amounts must be checked to prevent duplicate compensation.

14. Transit damage and replacement policy [REPLACE-01]

Visible transit damage should be reported within seven calendar days of delivery. Support requests the order reference, a description of the damage, photos of the affected item, the outer packaging, and the shipping label with unnecessary personal details covered. A product that smokes, sparks, overheats abnormally, or has exposed live wiring must not be powered for photographs or troubleshooting. Safety takes priority over collecting evidence.

When transit damage or a manufacturing defect is confirmed, support may propose a like-for-like replacement if the order and affected item are eligible and replacement stock is available. Like-for-like means the same SKU and region-appropriate variant, not an automatic upgrade. A different color, substitute model, store credit, or refund requires customer consent and authorized review. Support must not substitute a refurbished unit for a new product without explicit consent.

After human approval, replacement handling normally takes two business days before dispatch, subject to verified stock and any required return inspection. Standard transit estimates then apply. A replacement is not shipped merely because a draft mentions it. If stock is unavailable, the reviewer offers the customer an approved wait option or eligible refund; an agent must not invent an arrival date for stock that has no confirmed replenishment date.

For a first approved defect replacement, Northstar pays the approved replacement shipping and necessary return shipping. The customer must not pay a fee to an individual support agent. Cross-shipping before receipt of the original item is an exception requiring Operations approval. The standard process is an approved return followed by inspection and replacement, unless written approval explicitly permits otherwise.

A replacement carries the remaining original warranty or 90 calendar days from replacement delivery, whichever is longer. This extension does not restart a full 12-, 24-, or 36-month warranty. If the same item has already been replaced and another problem is reported, check the replacement history and investigate rather than creating an unlimited sequence of automatic replacements.

15. Warranty coverage and repair boundaries [WARRANTY-01]

Manufacturing-defect warranty begins on the original product delivery date. The warranty lasts 36 months for Orbit NA-270. It lasts 24 months for new TypeWave NK-100, GlowFlex NL-200, AeroDock ND-800, Link65 NP-650, RiseStand NS-300, FocusCam NC-100, ClearCall NH-220, and DeskSense NL-320. It lasts 12 months for Transit NS-140, QuietClick NM-210, Link100 NCB-100, Hub4 NH-400, GlideMat NM-900, AirCool NF-150, and Renew NK-100-R.

Warranty covers verified defects in materials or manufacturing under intended use. It excludes accidental drops, liquid damage, improper power adapters, normal consumable wear, unauthorized modification, unsuitable mounting, cable crushing, and operation outside published limits, unless a mandatory legal obligation applies. A product failing after the change-of-mind return window is not automatically excluded from warranty review. The correct route depends on the defect, product, dates, and evidence.

For a warranty review, collect the order reference, SKU, serial number when the product has one, a concise symptom description, the first observed date, and relevant non-dangerous troubleshooting results. Not every product has a serial number; lack of one on a sleeve or desk mat is not proof of fraud. Proof of purchase must come from an authorized order record or an approved business invoice. The agent should not invent a serial-number format.

The standard warranty route is assessment followed by an approved repair or replacement. An immediate full-price refund outside the initial defect period is not guaranteed. Repair turnaround depends on the inspected fault and parts availability; this document provides no fixed universal repair completion time. A replacement follows the remaining-original-warranty-or-90-days rule in REPLACE-01.

Northstar does not instruct customers to open mains-powered adapters, bypass thermal protection, solder circuit boards, or defeat a privacy or safety mechanism. If a device presents a possible electrical or structural hazard, stop the troubleshooting sequence and route to Safety. A warranty claim is a support process, not permission to continue using a dangerous product while waiting for a response.

16. DeskCare Priority subscription [PLAN-01]

DeskCare Priority is an optional customer-support subscription. The individual plan costs USD 6 per month or USD 60 per year, before applicable tax. The annual price is USD 12 less than twelve monthly payments of USD 6. DeskCare provides priority routing, a four-business-hour initial response target during published support hours, and guided setup assistance for Northstar products. It does not include a dedicated engineer, weekend cover, or guaranteed same-day resolution.

DeskCare is not insurance and does not extend a product's manufacturing-defect warranty. It does not cover accidental damage, theft, loss, liquid spills, unlimited replacement products, or free expedited shipping. A subscriber's physical-product refund and replacement requests follow the same verification and human approval rules as other customers. Priority support is a response benefit, not automatic financial eligibility.

DeskCare renews at the end of the paid monthly or annual term unless cancelled. Cancellation stops the next renewal and access continues until the paid period ends. Monthly fees are not prorated for a partial month. A first annual subscription may be refunded if requested within seven calendar days of initial purchase and no Priority assistance has been used. This annual exception does not apply automatically to renewals or to a subscription with a completed Priority support session.

When an annual refund exception is approved, the subscription ends rather than continuing for the remainder of the year. A normal cancellation without a refund preserves access until the original term end. An agent must inspect the actual subscription start date, renewal status, and assistance history. The knowledge document supplies the policy but contains no live subscriber list or account billing state.

Physical products and DeskCare are separate purchases for eligibility calculations. DeskCare does not count toward the USD 100 free-standard-shipping threshold, and WELCOME10 does not discount it. DeskCare subscription changes and business support contracts are reviewed by Billing or the business account team. A proposed physical-order refund cannot be treated as cancellation of a recurring subscription.

17. Business purchasing and team onboarding [B2B-01]

Business buyers can request a written quote from business@northstar.example. A standard bulk-pricing review starts at 10 units of the same SKU in one purchase. A review does not guarantee a specific discount. Exact business pricing, payment schedules, freight, invoicing, and returns require an approved quote or signed agreement. The consumer WELCOME10 coupon cannot be combined with a negotiated business quote.

Business quote validity is 14 calendar days unless the quote states another period. A quote is not an inventory reservation until the agreement and payment conditions are met. Northstar does not publish universal net-30 terms, a fixed enterprise discount, or credit approval criteria in this knowledge base. The business team must confirm those terms for the account. Frontline agents must not issue a made-up purchase order number or promise financing.

For a team order, the business team collects the organization name, authorized purchasing contact, quantities, SKUs, delivery countries, required-by date, and invoice requirements. It does not collect employee passwords, personal card details, or unnecessary identity documents. Multi-address delivery needs an approved allocation list and explicit review of shipping and privacy requirements. Consumer free shipping is not automatically a business freight agreement.

Guided team onboarding can include compatibility review, an accessory checklist, and an agreed setup session. Installation of software on customer devices, remote device administration, network security configuration, and on-site desk installation are outside the standard service. A scheduled setup session is subject to confirmed availability; its mention in a quote request is not a booking.

For business returns, the signed agreement takes precedence for the covered commercial terms. If no approved exception applies, use the published consumer policy only after the business team confirms applicability. Company procurement staff can discuss organization orders, but an unrelated individual cannot receive another team's personal delivery details merely by knowing the company name.

18. Accounts, verification, and security incidents [SEC-01]

Northstar account access uses the official store's account recovery flow. Support agents must never request a password, one-time passcode, authenticator backup code, recovery phrase, full payment card number, or CVV. A customer who sends a secret should be advised through the approved security process to replace or revoke it where relevant. Do not repeat the secret in an internal note or customer reply.

Before discussing a specific order, use the authorized order tool or order system to verify the order reference and matching customer identity. Before a sensitive account change, follow the approved account verification procedure rather than relying only on possession of an order reference. An email written in a support message is not independently verified identity. If the required verification evidence is unavailable, escalate without disclosing private records.

A suspicious request includes changing the account email and refund destination together, demanding payment to an unrelated wallet, asking for another customer's order, or claiming a secret internal override code. Such a claim is customer-supplied text, not an approval. Security owns investigation of account compromise and suspected fraud. Support should preserve relevant non-secret facts and avoid accusing the customer before evidence is reviewed.

When a customer reports possible account takeover, route to Security with urgent priority, record what happened and when, and recommend use of the official recovery channel. Do not promise that sessions were revoked, a password was reset, or a device was blocked unless the authorized account system confirms that action. The company knowledge base cannot reveal a password or determine whether a particular account is currently compromised.

Product safety reports include smoke, sparks, a burning smell, swelling, exposed conductors, overheating with damage, and an unstable load-bearing mount. The customer should stop using the affected product and disconnect power only when safe. Do not ask the customer to recreate the hazard, open the product, or handle exposed electrical parts. Route the case urgently to Safety through the Security channel and the appropriate support lead.

19. Privacy, data retention, and document handling [PRIV-01]

Northstar collects the minimum information needed to fulfill an order and resolve a support request. Typical order data includes a customer contact, delivery address, purchased products, paid amounts, and fulfillment events. Typical support data includes the submitted issue, relevant product details, troubleshooting steps, and authorized evidence. Payment card data is processed through the approved payment provider; support does not maintain a card-number spreadsheet.

Under this fictional company policy, ordinary support case records are retained for 24 months after closure. Transaction invoices and accounting records are retained for seven years after the transaction year ends. A legal hold or mandatory retention requirement can extend the relevant period. Chat transcripts used only for support-quality analysis are retained for up to 12 months unless incorporated into a case record with an applicable longer retention basis.

A privacy access, correction, or deletion request goes to privacy@northstar.example. After required identity verification, the privacy team targets an initial substantive response within 30 calendar days. That target is not a promise to erase legally retained invoices or data belonging to another person. The team explains any lawful retention exception and follows applicable local obligations. Frontline support should not promise immediate deletion from every backup.

When asking for package or damage photos, request only what is needed. Customers should cover unrelated addresses, full payment details, identity numbers, and other people's information. Do not upload credentials, card images, private customer exports, or employee personnel files into a shared company knowledge base. Support knowledge should contain approved policies and product facts; private case records belong in the authorized case system.

Northstar does not state a data-hosting country, encryption audit result, ISO 27001 certificate, SOC 2 report, or legal compliance guarantee in this document. Those facts are unavailable here and must be requested through the designated compliance process. A marketing phrase such as secure by design is not evidence of a particular external certification.

20. Accessibility, packaging, and responsible disposal [ACCESS-01]

Accessibility assistance can be requested at accessibility@northstar.example or through ordinary support. Available demonstration accommodations include written setup instructions, a plain-language summary, and a request for larger-text electronic instructions. Support should ask which format is useful rather than infer a disability or request a medical diagnosis. A particular accommodation is confirmed only after the responsible team accepts the request.

Northstar does not claim that every product is medically suitable, approved as an assistive device, or compatible with every accessibility tool. For a product-selection question, describe the published connection modes, dimensions, controls, and limits. If a customer needs information not in the catalog, seek product review. Do not promise that a keyboard, headset, or stand will treat a health condition or prevent injury.

Most Northstar cardboard packaging is recyclable where local facilities accept it. Remove electronic components, foam inserts, and any non-paper packing material before placing cardboard in an appropriate recycling stream. Local acceptance varies. The company does not claim all packaging is plastic-free, all products are carbon-neutral, or that this document is a carbon audit.

Electronic products and batteries should be handled through the customer's local approved electronic-waste or battery collection program. Do not place a damaged battery in ordinary mail or general waste. Northstar has no general home collection service for used electronics in this policy version. A return authorization for a warranty case is distinct from a public recycling program.

21. Troubleshooting playbooks [TECH-01]

TypeWave NK-100: Bluetooth pairing or wrong key layout

For TypeWave pairing, confirm the keyboard is charged, switched on, and in Bluetooth mode rather than receiver mode. Remove an obsolete saved pairing entry on the computer and repeat the documented pairing procedure. Test within a short distance without a metal obstruction. If the receiver is being used, confirm the receiver is connected to the intended computer and that any required USB-C adapter supports data. Charging alone does not create a wired keyboard connection.

For swapped modifier keys, check TypeWave's physical Windows/macOS switch and the operating system's keyboard layout. Confirm the problem occurs in more than one application. Record the exact operating system and connection mode before escalating. Do not advise an undocumented factory-reset key combination or firmware download link. This knowledge base does not publish model-specific pairing shortcuts or downloadable firmware packages.

AeroDock ND-800: no external display

For AeroDock with no HDMI picture, first confirm the laptop's exact USB-C port supports DisplayPort Alternate Mode. Then check monitor input selection, HDMI cable capability, a direct connection without an unverified adapter chain, and operating-system display settings. A data-only USB-C laptop port cannot produce video through this hub. A Link100 cable cannot supply USB-C video, even though it supports charging.

If the host supports video but flicker occurs, inspect the cable and target resolution, reduce the display mode as a diagnostic step, and check whether the host can sustain the requested output. Do not promise 4K 60 Hz without host and cable support. A dock becoming slightly warm in normal use is different from a burning smell, visible damage, or unsafe heat; the latter signs require stopping use and safety escalation.

AeroDock ND-800: slow charging or network problems

For slow laptop charging through AeroDock, note the charger's wattage, the cable rating, and the laptop's required input. AeroDock may reserve up to 15 W. A Link65 source leaves at most 50 W for the laptop, and a 90 W laptop is not promised full-speed charging. Do not claim the hub creates extra power. If the laptop charges directly but not through the hub, record both results and the negotiated power information when the operating system exposes it.

For Ethernet problems, confirm the Ethernet cable is seated, the router port works, and the operating system sees a network adapter. Test a known working cable and distinguish no network link from an internet service outage. Gigabit link capability is not a guarantee of gigabit internet throughput. Support does not ask for a router password or recommend disabling all security controls as a permanent fix.

GlowFlex NL-200: no light or flicker

For a GlowFlex lamp that will not turn on, confirm the supplied adapter, wall outlet, and barrel connector are seated and visually undamaged. Check the touch control and try a normal brightness setting. Test the outlet with an unrelated safe device if convenient. Do not substitute a random USB-C charger, open the adapter, or bypass its power supply. Stop immediately if there is exposed wiring, a burning smell, or heat damage.

For an intermittent lamp, record whether the symptom changes with normal control operation and whether the original adapter is used. A video may help only if it can be obtained without recreating a

hazard. The published color range is 2700-6500 K; the presence of several color settings is normal. GlowFlex has no internal battery, so operation while unplugged is not expected.

FocusCam NC-100: black image or missing microphone

For a black FocusCam image, open the physical privacy shutter, select FocusCam in the application, check operating-system camera permissions, and close another application that may hold the camera. Test a direct USB connection before adding a hub. The supported maximum is 1080p at 30 frames per second, not 4K. Lighting and network quality can affect a meeting even when the camera is functioning normally.

For a missing microphone, select the intended input device and check microphone permissions independently from camera permissions. Closing FocusCam's lens shutter does not establish that its microphones are muted. Record the meeting application, operating system, and whether the operating system's sound test detects input. Do not request an account password to change application settings.

ClearCall NH-220 and QuietClick NM-210

For ClearCall audio issues, select the headset as output and input, inspect the inline mute control, inspect the application's mute state, and test another USB data port. ClearCall is wired and cannot be paired using Bluetooth. Its microphone noise reduction does not promise active noise cancellation in the earcups. A damaged cable or connector should be escalated rather than repaired by the customer.

For QuietClick pointer lag, use a fresh correctly fitted AA battery, confirm the selected wireless mode, move the receiver away from interference, and test a suitable mouse surface. Check the battery compartment for a stored receiver before treating it as missing. Do not plug a charging cable into the mouse; QuietClick is not rechargeable. Stop use if battery leakage or damaged contacts are present.

Mechanical fit and maintenance

For an Orbit arm that drifts, verify the monitor weighs 2-9 kg without its original stand, the VESA pattern is compatible, and installation followed the supplied guide. Do not adjust a loaded arm in a way that allows the screen to fall. If the desk is glass, hollow-core without an approved reinforcement, or outside the 10-60 mm clamp range, the installation is unsupported. A compatibility review is required before recommending hardware changes.

For a sleeve fit issue, compare the laptop's complete external dimensions with Transit's internal 345 x 245 x 24 mm space, including any bulky case. For a new GlideMat that curls, allow up to 48 hours on a flat surface; do not heat it with an iron. For AirCool noise, disconnect it before inspecting surface dust or obvious damage. For DeskSense, confirm flat-monitor mechanical fit and an adequate 5 V, 2 A power source.

22. Support workflow, queues, and human approval [OPS-01]

The normal support sequence is: read the issue, identify the customer and relevant order, retrieve the applicable policy, inspect authorized order records, propose a response or action, obtain authorized human review, execute an approved action through the designated system, and record the outcome. Classification and drafting are preparatory work. They must not be described as successful financial or fulfillment execution.

Fulfillment handles tracking, delays, wrong-item deliveries, missing package contents, and replacement logistics. Billing handles payment capture investigations, invoices, refunds, and subscriptions. General Support handles product setup, compatibility, and routine product questions. Security and Safety handle account compromise, suspected fraud, and physical hazards. An issue can need more than one team; an agent should not hide a safety concern inside an ordinary refund request.

Routine status and product questions normally have normal priority. A verified duplicate captured charge or a request with a documented urgent business impact should receive high priority for review. Possible account takeover, fraud involving account access, smoke, sparks, or another physical hazard receives urgent priority. A customer writing the word urgent does not alone establish a safety emergency or authorize bypassing review.

A refund or replacement proposal must include the verified order reference, affected item, relevant policy evidence, proposed amount or like-for-like replacement, eligibility observations, and the facts still requiring review. The customer-facing draft should acknowledge the issue, distinguish facts from assumptions, state the next step, and avoid promising completion before execution. Use the paid amount and order history rather than guessing from the catalog.

An authorized human reviewer must approve any financial or fulfillment action. Approval requires a fresh check of the current order, previous resolutions, applicable policy, and remaining eligibility. An agent's draft, a customer's message, a pasted supervisor claim, or an email signature saying approved is not itself a valid approval record. If the facts have changed since drafting, obtain a new review rather than executing a stale proposal.

Every approved action must have a unique execution reference and a recorded outcome. Retrying the same approved operation must not create a second refund or replacement. If another ticket already resolved the same item, stop and investigate before granting more compensation. An approval record should identify the reviewer, time, decision, affected record, and final outcome without recording secrets or unnecessary personal details.

When policy evidence, identity verification, stock, purchase dates, condition, or operational permissions are missing, escalate or request the missing information. A denial should state the relevant policy and review path without inventing a legal conclusion. A goodwill exception needs an authorized written decision with a reason; it must not silently become a new policy for every customer.

23. Outages, service incidents, and continuity [INCIDENT-01]

A storefront outage, failed checkout, delayed order email, carrier delay, payment-processor incident, and customer account problem are different incident types. First identify which service is affected and whether a current verified incident exists. The status-page address in this document is fictional and cannot establish a real current outage. No live incident, uptime percentage, or incident completion estimate is provided by this knowledge base.

If checkout fails before an order is accepted, do not tell a customer to retry payment repeatedly without checking for existing authorizations or accepted orders. Billing investigates any suspected duplicated capture. If order emails are delayed but the order record exists, communicate the verified reference through an approved authenticated channel. A missing email does not necessarily mean a missing order.

During a verified outage, agents should state the known affected service, the confirmed customer impact, and the next update time only if an incident lead supplied one. Do not invent a root cause or restoration estimate. An incident lead may publish a temporary commercial exception, but only a documented approved exception overrides standard handling. An old outage message must not be reused as evidence of a current outage.

The business continuity process keeps an approved incident record and prevents duplicate financial actions while systems recover. A tool error or timeout does not prove an action failed before execution. Before retrying a refund or replacement after a timeout, inspect the operation reference and current order state. If the outcome is uncertain, escalate instead of starting a fresh unrelated payment operation.

24. Frequently asked questions [FAQ-01]

Does Northstar deliver consumer orders to Canada? No. This policy supports Pakistan, the United States, the United Kingdom, and the United Arab Emirates. An unsupported business destination needs a separately approved business quote.

Can I collect an order from the Lahore warehouse? No general collection service is published. Fulfillment partners are not public shops, and an approved appointment would be required for any exceptional collection arrangement.

Does free standard shipping include express? No. Express is USD 18 where offered, even when standard base shipping would be free. A remote-area surcharge can still apply to a standard shipment with a zero base charge.

Does express mean dispatch on the same day? No. Express changes the estimated carrier transit service; the normal processing period still applies unless an approved commitment says otherwise.

Can a USD 99 merchandise order get free standard shipping? Not under the USD 100 post-discount merchandise threshold. Tax or a DeskCare fee does not raise the merchandise subtotal for that calculation.

Can I stack WELCOME10 with Home Office Essentials? No, unless a separately approved campaign explicitly permits it. The normal WELCOME10 rules exclude bundles and allow only one promotional code.

Does a 100 W Link100 cable make Link65 a 100 W charger? No. Link65 remains a maximum 65 W source, and the attached device must support the negotiated power profile.

Will AeroDock display video from every USB-C port? No. The host port must support DisplayPort Alternate Mode. A data-only USB-C port cannot provide HDMI video through AeroDock.

Is Link100 suitable as a monitor cable? No. Its USB 2.0 data and charging specification does not include USB-C video or Thunderbolt support.

Can I use GlowFlex without its power adapter? No. GlowFlex has no internal battery and requires its supplied mains adapter.

Does TypeWave work as a wired keyboard when charging? No. Its USB-C connection charges it; typing uses Bluetooth or the wireless receiver.

Can QuietClick be recharged? No. QuietClick uses one replaceable AA battery and has no charging port. The battery is not included.

Does ClearCall provide active noise cancellation for the wearer? No. Its specified noise reduction is for the microphone, not active cancellation in the earcups.

Does FocusCam's privacy shutter mute the microphones? No. It covers the lens. Microphone access and muting must be checked separately.

Will a 14-inch laptop always fit Transit 14? No. Compare the laptop's external dimensions against 345 x 245 x 24 mm, including any added case.

Can an opened new nonfaulty product be returned after 20 days? Not under the standard 14-day opened-product change-of-mind policy. A defect or another applicable right requires its own review rather than an automatic rejection of every claim.

Is an unopened new nonfaulty item eligible for a return request on day 30? Yes, if the other conditions are met and the request is submitted by the destination's end of day 30. Authorization and inspection are still required.

Do defect returns have a 15% restocking deduction? Confirmed manufacturing defects within the initial 30 days, transit damage, and Northstar fulfillment errors do not. The opened nonfaulty rule must not be applied to a confirmed fault case.

Can a customer ship a return immediately without contacting support? No. An approved return authorization must identify the correct destination and shipping method first.

When will a refund reach a card? Inspection normally takes three business days after return receipt, merchant submission takes two business days after approval, and the bank may take another five to ten business days. The actual case must be checked; do not promise an instant credit.

Can a refund be sent to a different person's bank account? No standard policy permits that. Refunds use the original payment method; unusual payment-routing requests require Billing and Security review.

What warranty does a replacement carry? A replacement carries the remaining original warranty or 90 calendar days from replacement delivery, whichever is longer. Replacing a 24-month-warranty keyboard does not restart the entire 24-month period.

Does DeskCare cover accidental liquid damage? No. It is priority support, not insurance or a warranty extension.

Can a DeskCare annual subscriber cancel renewal and keep the remaining paid access? Yes, when cancelling without a refund. An approved first-annual-term refund exception instead ends the subscription.

Can a support agent approve their own financial action just because the customer agrees? No. An authorized human reviewer must inspect the evidence and approve the financial or fulfillment action through the approved process.

Where can I find today's stock count or the current price in PKR? Not in this fixed knowledge document. Stock, live currency conversion, order status, processor events, and confirmed arrival dates require the appropriate current operational source.

25. Policy governance and known information gaps [GOV-02]

Customer Experience Operations owns this document. Product Engineering reviews specifications and compatibility facts. Finance reviews paid-amount, invoice, coupon, and subscription terms. Fulfillment reviews shipping, returns, and replacement handling. Security and Privacy review sensitive-data handling and incident procedures. A proposed policy change requires approval by its accountable owner before publication.

Version 1.0 establishes the demonstration catalog, regional coverage, USD prices, 30-day unopened new-product window, 14-day opened new-product window, 15% opened-new restocking deduction, 14-day refurbished window with 10% deduction, and human-reviewed financial action policy. There is no older approved policy version in this knowledge pack. A customer asserting that a previous version allowed a 90-day return must supply evidence for human review; the agent should not invent a historical policy.

Review target: once per quarter or immediately after an approved material change. The next routine review target is 1 February 2027. A review target is not an automatic expiry date. An owner can publish a new approved version sooner. The effective date, not the upload date or file creation date, identifies the commercial policy version being described.

This document intentionally does not contain real-time stock, live shipment tracking, named customer purchase records, payment transactions, passwords, API keys, internal authentication tokens, bank accounts, exact tax rates, tax registration numbers, live currency rates, legal advice, employment vacancies, or public security certifications. Missing information should be described as unavailable and obtained from an authorized source when necessary.

Northstar's fictional procedures describe the company's intended operating policy. A chatbot connected only to this document can explain those procedures but cannot verify a real order, inspect a bank account, email a customer, execute a refund, reserve stock, or ship a replacement. Such operations require the authorized business system, appropriate permissions, and the human approvals described above.

26. Glossary and quick reference [GLOSSARY-01]

Paid item amount means the invoiced price of an item after allocated discounts, excluding separately accounted shipping and tax. Restocking deduction means the published reduction for an eligible nonfaulty return, calculated from the paid item amount. Manufacturing defect means a verified materials or production fault under intended use. Transit damage means damage associated with transport and investigated using delivery and package evidence.

Return authorization means the approved instructions for a particular return. Like-for-like replacement means the same eligible SKU and regional variant unless another remedy is expressly approved. Warranty remaining means the unexpired portion of the original warranty period. Refurbished means tested previously handled stock sold under the refurbished listing, not an unadvertised substitute for a new product.

DisplayPort Alternate Mode means a host USB-C video capability required by AeroDock's HDMI path. USB Power Delivery means negotiated charging profiles between compatible equipment. A 5 A electronic marker identifies a cable capability; it does not increase a charger's output. VESA mounting pattern means the monitor mounting-hole arrangement, such as 75 x 75 mm or 100 x 100 mm.

PKT means Pakistan Standard Time, UTC+5. A calendar day includes weekends. A support business day follows published support operating days. A shipping business day follows the dispatch warehouse and carrier operating calendar. A proposed action is awaiting decision; approved is a human decision; executed is a separately verified operational outcome. Those states must not be used interchangeably.

End of Northstar Workspace demonstration company knowledge base, version 1.0.